

ESSENTIAL

Financial Requirements Overview

The published cost-of-living formula and acceptable evidence

VERIFY BEFORE YOU APPLY

Fees, forms, and processing times change without notice. This guide reflects publicly documented procedures as commonly published; treat every dollar figure, form number, and timeline here as a starting point, and confirm the current version on the official government site before you submit anything or pay any fee.

This route has a published, formula-based requirement

Unlike the Visitor visa (which has no fixed minimum - see that visa type's own documents if you're applying for both), the Student visa's financial requirement is a specific, published formula covering course costs, an annual living-cost figure, and travel, with additional published amounts for any accompanying family members.

The formula

- Course fees payable: your course costs as stated on your CoE (minus any amount already paid, if your evidence shows it)
- Living costs: a published annual amount for the primary applicant - this figure is updated periodically by the department and is not reproduced as a fixed figure here
- Travel costs: a reasonable estimate for return travel
- If family members are accompanying you, additional published annual amounts are added per accompanying adult and per accompanying child, plus their own OSHC and any school costs for school-age dependants

Total required = course fees payable + living costs (primary applicant, plus any accompanying family additions) + travel costs. See the Financial Planning Calculator (Premium tier) for a live version of this formula you can fill in with your own numbers and the current published amounts.

Acceptable evidence

- Personal or parental bank statements showing an ongoing, genuine pattern of funds, not a single recent large deposit
- An official student/education loan approval letter, where applicable
- A scholarship or government sponsorship letter, for the portion it covers
- Evidence of school-age dependants' schooling costs, if bringing accompanying family

Red flags

- A large, recent, unexplained deposit shortly before applying
- Evidence that doesn't clearly match the course costs on your CoE
- A sponsorship letter that doesn't clearly state the amount and duration of the commitment